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Method · August 2023

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Emotion Regulation Questionnaire-Short Form (ERQ-S)

We would like to ask you some questions about your emotional life, in particular, how you control (that is, regulate and manage) your emotions. The questions below involve two distinct aspects of your emotional life. One is your emotional experience, or what you feel like inside. The other is your emotional expression, or how you show your emotions in the way you talk, gesture, or behave. Although some of the following questions may seem similar to one another, they differ in important ways. For each item, please answer using the following scale:

		Strongly disagree	---	---	Neutral	---	---	Strongly agree
1	When I want to feel more <i>positive</i> emotion (such as joy or amusement), I <i>change the way I'm thinking</i> about the situation.	1	2	3	4	5	6	7
2	I keep my emotions to myself.	1	2	3	4	5	6	7
3	When I want to feel less <i>negative</i> emotion (such as sadness or anger), I <i>change the way I'm thinking</i> about the situation.	1	2	3	4	5	6	7
4	I control my emotions by <i>not expressing them</i> .	1	2	3	4	5	6	7
5	I control my emotions by <i>changing the way I think</i> about the situation I'm in.	1	2	3	4	5	6	7
6	When I am feeling <i>negative</i> emotions, I make sure not to express them.	1	2	3	4	5	6	7

ERQ-S Scoring Instructions

The Emotion Regulation Questionnaire-Short Form (ERQ-S; Preece, Petrova, Mehta, & Gross, 2023) is a 6-item short form of the Emotion Regulation Questionnaire (ERQ; Gross & John, 2003).

Like the ERQ, the ERQ-S is designed to assess habitual use of two common emotion regulation strategies, *cognitive reappraisal* (i.e., changing the way one is thinking about a situation in order to change its emotional impact) and *expressive suppression* (i.e., suppressing behavioral expression of emotion). Separate scale scores can be derived from the ERQ-S for each of these strategies, with higher scores indicating higher usage of that strategy.

High usage of cognitive reappraisal is typically associated with good well-being and interpersonal outcomes, whereas high usage of expressive suppression is typically associated with poor well-being and interpersonal outcomes (Gross & John, 2003). The ERQ-S has demonstrated strong psychometric properties, performing similarly to the full ERQ (see Preece, Petrova, Mehta, & Gross, 2023).

Scoring:

Two scale scores can be derived from the ERQ-S:

- **Cognitive reappraisal:** sum items 1, 3, and 5.
- **Expressive suppression:** sum items 2, 4, and 6.

To interpret scores, we recommend that the scores of the examinee be compared to the scores of an appropriate normative sample. To help facilitate this interpretation, in the below table are normative data from a representative sample of adults from the United States.

	USA General Community Sample (N = 508)				
	M	SD	Range	Cronbach's α	McDonald's ω
Cognitive reappraisal	14.39	4.06	3-21	.87	.87
Expressive suppression	12.25	4.46	3-21	.76	.77

- **High scores:** Scores 1 standard deviation (SD) or more above the mean can be considered 'high' (i.e., high usage of that emotion regulation strategy). Using the above USA norms this would be a score of 19+ for Cognitive Reappraisal or 17+ for Expressive suppression.
- **Average scores:** Scores within 1 SD of the mean can be considered 'average' (i.e., average usage of that emotion regulation strategy). Using the above USA norms this would be a score between 11 and 18 for Cognitive reappraisal or between 8 and 16 for Expressive Suppression.
- **Low scores:** Scores 1 SD or more below the mean can be considered 'low' (i.e., low usage of that emotion regulation strategy). Using the above USA norms this would be a score of 10 or less for Cognitive Reappraisal or 7 or less for Expressive Suppression.

ERQ-S Citation: Preece, D. A., Petrova, K., Mehta, A., & Gross, J. J. (2023). The Emotion Regulation Questionnaire-Short Form (ERQ-S): A 6-item Measure of Cognitive Reappraisal and Expressive Suppression. *Journal of Affective Disorders*, 340, 855-861.

Contacts:

- Dr. David A. Preece, Curtin University, Australia - david.preece@curtin.edu.au
- Kate Petrova, Stanford University, USA - kpetrova@stanford.edu
- Ashish Mehta, Stanford University, USA - ashm@stanford.edu
- Professor James J. Gross, USA - gross@stanford.edu

Stanford Psychophysiology Laboratory: <https://spl.stanford.edu/>

Perth Emotion & Psychopathology Lab: www.emotionpsychopathologylab.com